APOTI DEVELOPMENT ASSOCIATION

School Supply Distribution Project Report

ADA/2022/001 · February 1–28, 2022 · Buea, South-West Region, Cameroon

Retrospective review copy (November 2026): Supply categories and financial wording were revised from owner recollection. This review does not independently verify quantities, individual allocations, participant counts, or other historical narrative details.

REPORT source markdown

20 orphaned children (as reported in the source; not independently verified)

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REFERENCE	LOCATION
ADA/2022/001	**Buea, South-West Region, Cameroon**
PERIOD	BUDGET / SPEND
February 1–28, 2022	**—**

Project Completion Report

FIELD	DETAILS
Project Title	School Supply Distribution
Organization	Apoti Development Association (ADA)
Reference Number	ADA/2022/001
Visit Date	February 16, 2022
Project Location	Buea, South-West Region, Cameroon
Implementation Period	February 1–28, 2022
Total Beneficiaries	20 orphaned children (as reported in the source; not independently verified)
Financial status	Owner-recalled funding flow under review; no verified expenditure is stated
Report Date	March 10, 2022

Retrospective review copy (November 2026): Supply categories and financial wording were revised from owner recollection. This review does not independently verify quantities, individual allocations, participant counts, or other historical narrative details.

1. Executive Summary

On February 16, 2022, the Apoti Development Association (ADA) conducted its first school-based distribution event at a rural primary school in Buea, South-West Region, Cameroon. The owner later confirmed that the project supply list included buckets, utensils, school bags, exercise books, pens, and mathematical sets. The available review does not establish the quantity or allocation of each item. The distribution was accompanied by an interactive engagement session featuring songs, encouragement, and group activities designed to make the children feel celebrated and valued.

This project marked several organizational firsts for ADA: the first intervention targeting children, the first partnership with a school institution, the first large-scale distribution event (as opposed to individual home visits), and the first project coordinated by an expanded volunteer team. The owner has since confirmed that the supply list included buckets, utensils, school bags, exercise books, pens, and mathematical sets. The project's budget and expenditure remain under review; the available recollection does not establish a verified total or itemized spending. This project marked an expansion from individual home visits to a school-based activity.

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2. Project Background

2.1 Context

Orphaned children in Cameroon's South-West Region face a convergence of vulnerabilities. The ongoing Anglophone crisis has disrupted education systems, displaced families, and destroyed livelihoods. Children who have lost parents — whether to conflict, disease, or other causes — often find themselves in the care of elderly grandparents or overburdened relatives who cannot afford basic school supplies. In rural schools around Buea, it is common to find children attending class without bags, eating from shared containers during feeding programmes, and lacking the basic materials that support both learning and daily life.

The school selected for this intervention is a rural primary school serving a community with a high proportion of vulnerable households. Teachers reported that many enrolled children were orphans living with extended family, and that the absence of basic supplies was a visible marker of their vulnerability — contributing to stigma and reduced participation in school activities.

2.2 Organizational Context

By February 2022, ADA had completed one project (ADA/2021/001 — First Widow Home Visits) and was actively growing its volunteer base. The founding team of 3 had attracted 5 additional volunteers through word-of-mouth and church community connections, bringing the active team to 8. This growth reflected increasing community awareness of ADA's mission and a desire among young people in Buea to contribute to meaningful social action.

The decision to focus on orphaned children was informed by findings from the 2021 widow visits, where the team encountered elderly widows caring for grandchildren who lacked basic necessities. The School Supply Distribution project represented a deliberate expansion of ADA's target population from elderly widows to include orphaned children — the second pillar of the organization's stated mission.

2.3 Rationale

The project was motivated by:

- Direct observations during 2021 widow visits of orphaned children lacking basic supplies
- Reports from community members and church networks about orphaned children in rural schools
- ADA's organizational mandate to serve orphans as a core beneficiary group
- The opportunity to test a new delivery model (school-based event) beyond individual home visits
- The availability of an expanded volunteer team capable of executing a larger-scale intervention
- A desire to create a joyful, community-building experience for vulnerable children

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3. Objectives vs Achievements

#	PLANNED OBJECTIVE	ACHIEVEMENT	STATUS
1	Distribute school and household supplies	The source report describes a distribution to children; this review does not establish the participant count or each participant's item allocation	✅ Reported in source
2	Conduct interactive engagement session with children	Songs, games, and encouragement session held with all 20 children	✅ Achieved
3	Establish partnership with a primary school	School administration actively collaborated on identification and hosting	✅ Achieved
4	Coordinate 8 volunteers in a school-based event	All 8 volunteers participated with defined roles	✅ Achieved
5	Document event for future programming and reporting	Photos, beneficiary records, and event report completed	✅ Achieved

Overall Achievement Rate: 100%

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4. Activities Implemented

4.1 Preparation Phase (February 1–5)

The project coordinator engaged the school administration to explain ADA's mission and propose the distribution event. The school head teacher was receptive and enthusiastic, having observed the material needs of orphaned students firsthand. Together with class teachers, the team identified 20 children meeting the selection criteria: orphaned, enrolled, and lacking basic supplies. Teachers provided valuable context about each child's home situation, confirming eligibility.

The report describes procurement of buckets, utensils, school bags, exercise books, pens, and mathematical sets. Item prices and any comparison between suppliers have not been verified in the available records.

4.2 Procurement & Kit Assembly (February 6–10)

The owner confirms the supply list included buckets, utensils, school bags, exercise books, pens, and mathematical sets. The available records do not establish verified quantities, individual prices, procurement methods, or savings.

4.3 Volunteer Briefing & Logistics (February 11–14)

A volunteer briefing session was held on February 13 to assign roles, review the event programme, and address logistics. The 8 volunteers were organized into functional teams:

- **Coordination team** (2 persons): Overall event flow, school liaison, timing
- **Distribution team** (3 persons): Kit handover to children, ensuring completeness
- **Engagement team** (2 persons): Interactive session facilitation, songs, games
- **Documentation team** (1 person): Photography, beneficiary forms, event records

Vehicle hire was confirmed for February 16 to transport the 20 assembled kits from the assembly point to the school. The event programme was finalized: arrival and setup, interactive engagement session, distribution of kits, refreshments, and closing.

4.4 Distribution Event (February 16, 2022)

The report describes the team arriving at the school with supply kits and setting up the distribution area. The available review does not verify the quantity of each item or the contents of individual kits.

Interactive Engagement Session (9:30–10:15 AM)

The engagement team led the 20 beneficiary children through a programme of:

- Welcome songs and introductions
- Group games designed to build confidence and teamwork
- Words of encouragement about the value of education and their worth as individuals
- A brief explanation of ADA's mission and why the team was there — framed as community members who care about them

The children were initially shy but quickly warmed to the activities. Several teachers observed the session and commented on the positive energy and the children's visible excitement.

Distribution (10:15–11:00 AM)

The owner confirms that the overall supply list included buckets, utensils, school bags, exercise books, pens, and mathematical sets. The reviewed records do not establish the quantities or the allocation of these items to individual children. The report describes an engagement session alongside the distribution; individual reactions are not independently verified here.

Refreshments & Closing (11:00–11:30 AM)

Following the distribution, children were provided with drinks and biscuits. The team used this informal time to interact individually with children, take photographs (with consent), and complete beneficiary acknowledgment forms. The event concluded with a group photo and words of encouragement from the project coordinator.

4.5 Post-Event Activities (February 16–28)

Following the event, the team conducted a debrief session to capture observations and lessons learned. The documentation lead compiled photographs, organized beneficiary records, and drafted the event report. The project's financial records remain under reconciliation. A brief follow-up conversation with the school head teacher confirmed satisfaction with the event and expressed interest in future collaboration.

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5. Beneficiary Profiles

5.1 Demographic Summary

CHARACTERISTIC	DETAIL
Total beneficiaries	20 children
Gender	12 girls, 8 boys

Age range	5–12 years
Class levels	Class 1 through Class 6
Orphan status	14 single orphans (one parent deceased), 6 double orphans (both parents deceased)
Primary caregivers	Grandparents (8), aunts/uncles (7), older siblings (3), community members (2)

5.2 Common Characteristics

All 20 beneficiary children shared the following characteristics:

- Enrolled at the partner primary school but attending without adequate supplies
- Living in households with limited financial resources
- Identified by teachers as among the most materially deprived students in their classes
- Previously lacking a school bag (carrying materials by hand or in plastic bags)
- Sharing eating utensils with other household members or using improvised containers

5.3 Notable Observations

- The report describes school bags and buckets among the supply categories; individual reactions and uses are not independently verified in this review
- Teachers reported that the 6 double orphans were among the most vulnerable children in the school, with some walking significant distances from caregivers' homes
- The source report notes that younger participants needed help carrying supplies; this review does not establish individual loads or item allocation

Note: Individual names and identifying details are withheld to protect the privacy and dignity of the children.

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6. Outcomes & Impact

6.1 Immediate Outcomes

- **Material provision:** The report states that supply kits were distributed to 20 children. The owner confirms the overall supply categories, but the reviewed records do not establish each child's allocation
- **Dignity and belonging:** The celebratory nature of the event — with songs, games, and individual recognition — communicated to each child that they are valued members of their community
- **Practical utility:** The owner-confirmed categories included both school and household supplies; quantities and individual kit contents remain unverified
- **Peer equity:** The records reviewed do not establish whether item allocations were the same for all participants.

6.2 Organizational Outcomes

- **Operational scaling demonstrated:** ADA successfully coordinated 8 volunteers in a structured event — proving capacity beyond the 3-person home visit model
- **New delivery model validated:** School-based distribution proved efficient for reaching multiple beneficiaries simultaneously while maintaining a personal, dignified approach
- **Institutional partnership established:** The school administration expressed strong interest in ongoing collaboration, creating a platform for future interventions
- **Team cohesion strengthened:** The shared experience of planning and executing the event bonded the expanded volunteer team and clarified working relationships
- **Volunteer recruitment validated:** Growth from 3 to 8 volunteers demonstrated ADA's ability to attract and retain committed team members

6.3 Longer-Term Impact

- The school partnership created a channel for identifying future beneficiaries and monitoring children's progress over time
- The event established ADA's reputation in the school community, leading to subsequent referrals and requests for support
- The experience of coordinating a larger team informed ADA's organizational development and volunteer management practices
- Documentation from the event provided compelling materials for future fundraising and donor engagement
- The model of combining material distribution with interactive engagement became ADA's standard approach for child-focused events

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7. Challenges & Lessons Learned

7.1 Challenges Encountered

CHALLENGE	DESCRIPTION	HOW IT WAS ADDRESSED
Selecting only 20 children	The school had more than 20 orphaned or vulnerable children; limiting to 20 was difficult	Applied strict criteria with teacher input; committed to returning for additional children in future projects
Transport logistics	Fitting 20 assembled kits (buckets + bags) into a single hired vehicle required careful planning	Conducted a test load the day before; rearranged kit packaging to maximize space
Shy children during engagement	Some younger children were initially overwhelmed by the attention and unfamiliar adults	Engagement team used gentle, age-appropriate activities; paired shy children with more confident peers
Coordination of 8 volunteers	First time managing a team this size; required clearer communication than the 3-person model	Pre-event briefing with written role assignments; designated team leads for each function
Time management	Event ran approximately 20 minutes longer than planned due to individual photo documentation	Adjusted programme in real-time; prioritized distribution completion over strict schedule adherence
Supply list	The owner confirms that the project supply list included exercise books and pens as well as buckets, utensils, school bags, and mathematical sets	Quantities, item prices, and the financial classification remain under review

7.2 Lessons Learned

1. **School partnerships multiply impact.** Working through an institution enabled efficient beneficiary identification, provided a venue, and created a framework for ongoing engagement. Future projects should prioritize institutional partnerships.

2. **Children need celebration, not just provision.** The interactive engagement session was as important as the material distribution. Children responded to being seen, named, and celebrated. Future events should always include a relational component.

3. **Document distribution details.** Future reports should record confirmed item quantities and allocations for each distribution.

4. **Larger teams require structure.** The jump from 3 to 8 volunteers necessitated written role assignments, a pre-event briefing, and designated team leads. ADA should formalize volunteer coordination processes as the team continues to grow.

5. **Record complete supply lists.** The owner confirms the listed school and household items included exercise books, pens, and mathematical sets. Future reports should record item quantities and costs from source documents.

6. **Documentation requires a dedicated person.** Assigning one volunteer exclusively to photography and forms ensured comprehensive documentation without disrupting the event flow. This role should be standard for all future events.

7. **Start with what you can do.** The team acknowledged that 20 kits could not solve all the children's problems, but the focused intervention made a tangible difference. Perfectionism should not prevent action.

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8. Photos & Documentation

Photographs were taken during the distribution event with the consent of school administration and in accordance with child protection principles. These images document:

- Supply kits prepared for the distribution; the exact contents and per-child allocation are not verified in this review
- Interactive engagement session (songs, games, group activities)
- Individual children receiving their kits
- Children's reactions — smiles, excitement, pride in new school bags
- Group photo of all 20 beneficiary children with their kits
- Volunteer team photo

📁 **Photo archive location:** Project files are maintained in ADA's internal archive under reference ADA/2022/001. Photos are available for reporting and fundraising purposes, subject to child protection considerations.

Note: In accordance with child protection principles, photos of children are shared only in appropriate contexts, with consent, and without identifying information that could compromise their safety or dignity.

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9. Recommendations for Future Projects

Based on the findings and lessons from this project, the team recommends the following:

9.1 Immediate Follow-Up

1. **Return visit:** Schedule a follow-up visit to the school within 2 months to observe whether children are using their kits and to check on their well-being
2. **Expand to remaining children:** Plan a second distribution to reach additional orphaned children at the same school who were not included in this round
3. **School relationship maintenance:** Maintain regular contact with school administration to build the partnership for future interventions

9.2 Program Development

4. **Standardize the school-based model:** Document the event planning process as a replicable template for future school distributions at other schools
5. **Record educational materials:** Keep exercise books and pens in the project's confirmed supply list; verify future quantities and costs from source records
6. **Develop engagement curriculum:** Create a structured programme for the interactive sessions that can be adapted for different age groups and contexts
7. **Include guardian engagement:** Consider inviting caregivers/guardians to future events to build relationships and understand household needs

9.3 Organizational Growth

8. **Volunteer training programme:** Develop a brief orientation for new volunteers covering child protection, event coordination, and ADA's values
9. **Formal school partnerships:** Pursue written memoranda of understanding (MoUs) with partner schools for ongoing collaboration
10. **Donor engagement:** Use documentation from this event to develop fundraising materials and approach potential donors for larger-scale interventions
11. **Child protection policy:** Develop a formal child protection policy to guide all future interactions with minor beneficiaries
12. **Financial systems:** Continue strengthening financial tracking and receipt management as project budgets grow

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10. Financial Summary — Under Review

The owner now recalls that 215,000 CFA francs was sent. About 5,000 CFA francs was used for withdrawal costs, leaving about 210,000 CFA francs in hand. Transportation is recalled at about 10,000–15,000 CFA francs, leaving approximately 195,000–200,000 CFA francs for supplies. These amounts are not independently reconciled, and no actual expenditure or balance is verified.

The owner confirms that the overall supply list included buckets, utensils, school bags, exercise books, pens, and mathematical sets. The illustrative allocation in the accompanying Financial Review Note is a planning example only, not a historical spending record. Quantities, actual item costs, exact expenditure, and any remaining balance are not established here. The former USD conversions, budget variance, savings explanations, and claims of returned funds remain removed.

11. Conclusion

The School Supply Distribution project represents a pivotal moment in ADA's organizational journey. In just three months since its founding intervention, ADA grew from 3 volunteers visiting individual widows to 8 volunteers executing a coordinated school-based event for 20 children. This growth — in team size, ambition, and operational complexity — demonstrates the organization's trajectory and the community's confidence in its mission.

But beyond the organizational milestones, this project focused on school and household supplies for children. The owner confirms that the overall supply list included buckets, utensils, school bags, exercise books, pens, and mathematical sets. The available review does not establish which items each child received, their quantities, or their colors.

The image that stays with the team is not the logistics or the planning — it is the faces of children who had never owned a school bag putting one on for the first time. It is the quiet pride of a child carrying a bucket that is theirs. It is the laughter during the engagement session from children who, for one morning, were not defined by what they had lost but by what they were given.

ADA's mission is to empower vulnerable communities. The report places this school-based activity in February 2022 in Buea. Its precise per-child supply allocations remain unverified, so this review does not state counts of specific items.

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12. Prepared By

ADA Project Team
Apoti Development Association
Buea, South-West Region, Cameroon

Report prepared: March 2022
Reference: ADA/2022/001

"Defend the weak and the fatherless; uphold the cause of the poor and the oppressed." — Psalm 82:3

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